

Ed made an appointment with an investment advisor to start building a portfolio. Esther made an appointment, too—with a different advisor. She ultimately interviewed three advisors before settling on one she liked: a woman named Beth. Beth's investment strategy made a lot of sense to Esther, and it centered on two points: be conservative, and diversify. Under Beth's guidance, Esther's investment portfolio began to prosper.

During Ed and Esther's fifth year in Toronto, Esther became pregnant. At the same time, they were presented with a unique business opportunity: to purchase a traditional Chinese bakery. They spent many days weighing the pros and cons, discussing it with one another and with their independent advisors. To their delight, their scrupulous saving and judicious investing had paid off. They were able to sell some stocks to get the liquidity they needed to make a down payment. The couple agreed to buy the bakery under two conditions: they would make the purchase under a joint ownership, and Esther would continue to handle the finances. They would approach the business the same way they had always approached their marriage: Esther would keep the books and monitor the cash flow to ensure the business was profitable. During those early months of running the business, Esther would often bring the crib into the office and balance the books at night while her newborn slept!

The bakery, whose sales had been flagging under the prior owner, began to flourish under the watchful eyes of both husband and wife. They understood their market, and they catered to it wisely. By the company's third year, they could boast almost a million in sales. By the fifth year, that figure had more than doubled. Esther and Ed split the profits 50/50: they each got 50 cents of every dollar. In other words, they got rich, separately and together. Because they were financially stable, they were able to bring other family members to Canada to help grow the business. Esther brought her mother over from China to provide childcare for their blossoming family (by this point, she had two young children). Ed brought his brother, who was a master pastry chef back home. With his help,